



# Jean-Michel Fayard

Tech lead / Senior Backend Developer / Kotlin, Java & more

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## Summary

-  **Jean-Michel Fayard**, 43 years old, 15 years of experience
-  **Role:** Team Lead / Senior Backend Developer / Developer Coach
-  **Education:** MSc in Computer Science (France & Germany)
-  **Location:** Berlin or full remote (Germany/EU time zone)
-  **French Nationality** (no visa need)
-  **Availability:** ASAP
-  **Contract:** Open to Permanent or Freelance
-  **Keywords:** AWS, Azure, Spring Boot, Ktor, Microservices, Kafka, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, Gitlab CI
-  **Languages:** French (native), English, German, Spanish (C1-C2), Japanese, Italian, Esperanto (basic)

## Experience

03/2024 - 06/2025

### Crédit Agricole Investment Bank

Senior Backend Developer  
Paris

 <https://www.ca-cib.com/en>

Championed the **adoption of AI** tools (GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT) to boost developer productivity and team confidence. Led hands-on workshops and created internal **guidelines** for responsible AI usage. Facilitated regular retrospectives to foster **continuous improvement** around AI-assisted workflows.

→ Result: **improved developer morale, faster onboarding**, and more intentional use of LLMs in daily work.

Contributed to a critical component of the bank's infrastructure — a real-time stream handling over 400,000 financial transactions daily, with end-of-day and end-of-month load peaks.

Improved system observability and alerting, with most root-cause analysis taking place in < 1 hour and higher operational confidence during production incidents.

**Skills:** Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, Kafka, Kubernetes, REST, GraphQL, Terraform, GitLab CI, ArgoCD, Helm, AWS, DevOps, Observability, OpenTelemetry, Iceberg

05/2023 - 05/2024

### Coaching for Developers

Entrepreneur  
Paris

 <https://substack.jmfayard.dev/>

Helped 13 developers land more fulfilling jobs through technical coaching, mock interviews, and career guidance

Gave interview preparation with consulting companies such as CodeBusters.

Created long-form, high-signal content with over **260 technical blog posts** written over 6+ years, covering both hard skills and dev career strategy.

Spoke at internal and public meetups on careers and culture-related questions.

**Skills:** Developer Coaching, Career Orientation, Technical Training, Writing, Public Speaking, Entrepreneurship, Developer Marketing

05/2020 - 02/2023

### Tignum

Team lead - Senior Backend Dev  
Remotely, from Paris

 <https://www.tignum.com/>

Saved 2 million euros to the company, as right hand of the CTO

Rescued a stalled project from over-engineering, AWS bill went from 10k€/month to 0.5k€/month.

Closed the Berlin office costing 16k€/month by moving to full remote.

Promoted a writing-first asynchronous work culture, reduced interruptions, faster onboarding.

Went from 20 devs to a better team of 12 devs.

Reduced 3 front-end project to 1 single codebase.

Broke down silos between backend and frontend.

Delivered more and better business features by making it simple to add, test and deploy new fonctionnalité.

03/2018 - 01/2019

### Payala

Senior Dev  
Remotely, from Berlin

 <https://www.payala.com/>

Invented a patented, cryptographically secure, offline-first payment system that extends financial access to unbanked populations — enabling instant, secure transactions without the need for reliable connectivity, a smartphone, or a bank account.

Developed an Android app used as a contactless payment terminal.

Collaborated with cryptography experts to integrate Java-based smartcards that securely store balances and perform local verification.

**Keywords:** Java, Kotlin, Go, Gin, Android, Java Smartcards, Offline-first systems, digital wallets, contactless smart cards, resilient architecture, cybersecurity, field-tested payments, financial inclusion

10/2014 - 10/2017

### Smart Mobile Factory

Backend and Android Developer  
Berlin, Germany

 <https://www.linkedin.com/company/smart-mobile-factory/>

Delivered or maintained 13 mobile projects — often juggling up to 3 in parallel — for various B2C and B2B clients. Collaborated closely with designers and product owners in agency-style environments with a culture of extreme ownership and developer-to-developer mentoring.

Started as an Android developer, then transitioned to backend development, switching fluidly between Java, TypeScript, PHP, and Kotlin depending on project needs.

Developed a pragmatic, polyglot mindset and became highly effective at ramping up on unfamiliar stacks through pair programming and peer-driven learning.

Built a solid technical foundation across mobile and backend ecosystems, gaining exposure to diverse codebases, architectures, and team dynamics.

**Skills:** Android, Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, PHP, Spring, Spring Boot, Symfony, REST APIs, Agile Delivery, Pair Programming, Tech Onboarding, Pragmatic Software Design

01/2007 - 01/2012

### Cap Gemini

Software Consultant  
Paris

 <https://www.capgemini.com/>

Consulting for big french companies (CAC 40)

Development and automated testing

Android programming

## Projects

- **gradle refreshVersions**  
Life is too short to google for dependencies and versions  
 <https://github.com/jmfayard/refreshVersions>
- **GitHub Workflows Kt**  
Authoring GitHub Actions workflows in Kotlin. You won't get back to YAML!  
 <https://typesafegithub.github.io/github-workflows-kt/>

## Profiles

-  [jmfayard](#)
-  [refreshVersions](#)
-  [jmfayard](#)
-  [jean-michel-fayard](#)

## Education

- 2006-01-07

### ENSIMAG

Master  
Computer Science

- 2006-01-07

### Universität Karlsruhe

Computer Science  
Master

2024

### Blendy

Recruitment

## Publications

**Technical blog**  
 <https://dev.to/jmfayard/>

## Languages

**Français**  
Natif

**English**  
C2

**Deutsch**  
C2

**Español**  
C2